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Chase Launches Shopping Platform That Lets Cardholders Pay With Points

BY PYMNTS
JUNE 12, 2025



[Chase](#) has launched a new online shopping experience that lets its cardholders pay with points, their card or both.

Dubbed “The Shops at Chase,” this platform also offers cardholders exclusive promotions and a seamless shopping experience in which their shipping information is pre-filled, the bank said in a Wednesday (June 11) [press release](#).



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The platform is now available for cardholders through the bank's [website](#) and [mobile app](#), according to the release. It includes a range of brands across travel, home, electronics, retail, fitness and other categories, according to the release.

It will soon add more brands to the curated selection as well as product recommendations based on cardholders' interests, per the release.

"By combining seamless shopping with top brands and rotating promotions, 'The Shops at Chase' is a new and convenient way for our customers to connect with brands they love," [Rich Muhlstock](#), head of offers and eCommerce and president of Chase Media Solutions at Chase, said in the release.

Credit card rewards, offers and benefits are a key driver of a consumer's decision about which card to use when making purchases, according to the PYMNTS Intelligence report, "[How Consumers Decide Which Credit Card to Pay With.](#)"

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The report found that more than one in four shoppers regularly switch between their credit cards when paying, planning in advance which card they will use for a given purchase to maximize their benefits.

Chase said in its Thursday press release that "The Shops at Chase" builds on the success of the bank's Apple Ultimate Rewards store.

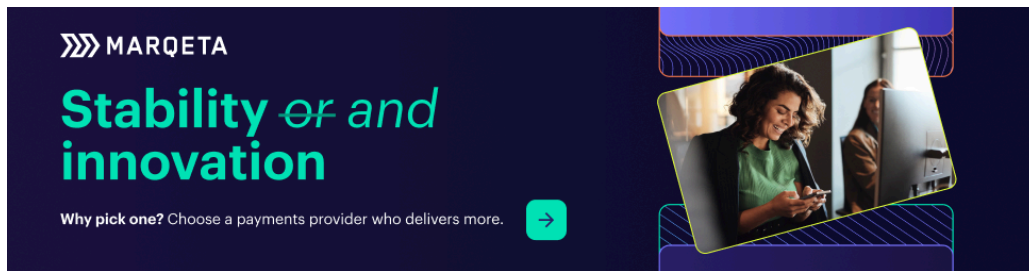
Launched in November 2018, the Apple Ultimate Rewards store lets Chase cardholders use [points](#), their card or a combination of both to



purchase Apple computers, phones, accessories and other products.

The bank said at the time that it launched Apple Ultimate Rewards to provide another option to cardholders seeking flexibility and choice with their rewards as well as make it easier for them to get the most value out of their rewards.

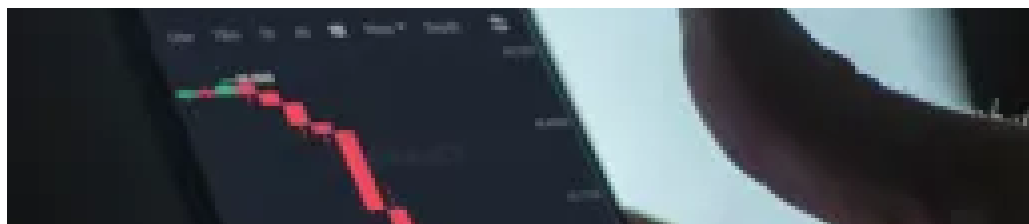
Chase's latest offering also joins other existing shopping benefits like Chase Offers, which lets Chase debit or credit cardholders earn cash back on purchases when they activate offers from brands.



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Gr4vy's Payment Orchestration Platform Integrates Affirm's Flexible Payment Options

BY PYMNTS
JANUARY 7, 2026



Merchants using [Gr4vy](#)'s cloud-based payment orchestration platform can now offer [Affirm's flexible payment options](#) to eligible customers through online and mobile channels.



The offering is enabled by a partnership between the two companies and the integration of those payment options with Gr4vy's platform, Gr4vy said in a Wednesday (Jan. 7) [press release](#).

With Affirm, Gr4vy merchants can allow approved customers to split purchases into biweekly or monthly payments, with no late or hidden fees, according to the release.

Merchants can enable these flexible payment options directly from the Gr4vy dashboard and, once approved by Affirm, deploy them across online and mobile checkout, per the release.

"Merchants want to meet customers where they are, with flexibility and trust," Gr4vy founder and CEO [John Lunn](#) said in the release. "By integrating Affirm directly into our orchestration platform, we're making it easier for businesses to offer transparent payment options that drive sales and customer loyalty without adding operational complexity."

Affirm CEO [Max Levchin](#) said during a November earnings call that his company's tests of cash flow underwriting help expand access to transparent credit and 0% [installment](#) options for "younger consumers and folks who are overlooked by the rest of the ecosystem," particularly millennials and Generation Z borrowers who "typically refuse to borrow on credit cards" but want flexibility to finance everyday purchases.

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Gr4vy's [payment orchestration platform](#) is designed to provide a single solution that enables companies to add providers, adjust routing and monitor performance. Doing so via a single cloud-native platform eliminates the need for merchants to juggle separate systems and workarounds, and helps them manage increasingly complex payment requirements, the company said in a Dec. 4 press release.

"Our aim has always been to give enterprises practical control over their payment stack without adding complexity," Lunn said in the release.

In other recent moves, Gr4vy supplied its [payment orchestration platform](#) to weight-loss solution provider [FuturHealth](#), strengthened its partnership with [payment services](#) provider [Worldline](#) to help merchants enter new markets and optimize payments globally, and enabled merchants to integrate [Mastercard's Merchant Cloud](#) and access advanced payment solutions such as [network tokenization](#), Click to Pay and Gateway services.

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Lloyds Looks to Tokenization to Improve Home-Buying Process



Why Messy Merchant Data Could Make B2B Payments More Expensive



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Lloyds Looks to Tokenization to Improve Home-Buying Process

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JANUARY 7, 2026



The CEO of U.K. bank [Lloyds](#) thinks tokenization can help improve the home-buying process.

That's according to the Financial Times (FT), which published an [interview](#) with [Charlie Nunn](#) on the topic Wednesday (Jan. 7).



Nunn, whose bank is the largest provider of home loans in the U.K., told the news outlet that he believes that “deposit tokenization,” or putting customer deposits on the [blockchain](#), could transform how Lloyds’ 23 million digital customers use their bank accounts, comparing its potential for disruption to the advent of the smartphone.

“The moment you picked up your first smartphone it was incredibly intuitive and joined up,” said Nunn, interviewed at the Financial Times’ Global Banking Summit last month. “We think ... in these next five years using these technologies could be that ‘wow moment’ where suddenly you realize it is more personalized, more intuitive and simpler.”

Mortgage lenders like Lloyds also hope that smart contracts can help cut out the various middle-men and account transfers that prolong the process of buying a home, which the FT says is notoriously slow in the U.K.

“Take mortgages: the whole conveyancing, document sharing, value exchange and payments process can be built into a smart contract, and the whole thing can be guided with or without a broker, with an agent giving advice to customers,” Nunn said.

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As the FT notes, Lloyds is not the only banking seeing potential in tokenization. Fellow British lenders [Barclays](#), [HSBC](#) and [NatWest](#) took part in a pilot with the trade association [UK Finance](#) in September to start testing [tokenized sterling deposits in transactions](#).



[Citigroup](#) in October credited tokenization for driving [record quarterly revenues](#). That bank has also [integrated](#) Citi Token Services with 24/7 USD Clearing, allowing institutional clients to move tokenized deposits across jurisdictions in near-real time without having to exit established account, compliance and settlement frameworks.

And JPMorgan's Kinexys platform has piloted a [dollar-denominated deposit token](#) operating on blockchain rails, backed by the bank's balance sheet and governed by standard know-your customer (KYC) and risk controls.

"In each case, tokenized deposits are positioned as [core infrastructure](#) rather than speculative instruments," PYMNTS CEO [Karen Webster](#) wrote recently.

"They support liquidity management, collateral mobility, programmable treasury operations and large-value settlement while mirroring existing account structures and legal protections," Webster added. "For CFOs and treasurers, the permissioned nature of these systems is not a constraint. It is the feature. It maps cleanly onto how they already think about counterparties, risk tiers and control."

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Why Messy Merchant Data Could Make B2B Payments More Expensive

BY PYMNTS
JANUARY 7, 2026



💡 Highlights

B2B card payments are shifting from good enough to invoice-level data as the standard, with card networks sunsetting Level 2 data and enforcing Level 3+ requirements (line-item details, accurate math) through AI validation.

Merchants that meet higher standards can benefit from lower fees, faster reconciliation, and reduced scrutiny.



The mechanics of many merchants' B2B payments have long been a source of frustration rather than transformation.

Negotiating interchange, switching processors or steering customers toward cheaper rails were the primary levers available to merchant finance teams, and the headaches of manual entry were simply accepted as part of doing business.

But in 2026, something fundamental is changing. The rules that govern B2B card payments, being rewritten by initiatives from [Visa](#), [Mastercard](#) and other networks, are elevating data quality from a compliance footnote to a driver of profit and working capital.

While Level 2 transaction data, such as sales tax and purchase order number, has traditionally represented the good-enough middle-tier for B2B payments (a step above just date and amount), Visa's launch of the Commercial Enhanced Data Program and related moves by Mastercard have put Level 3 and above as the new benchmark. That requires merchants to include line-item details, such as product descriptions, SKUs, unit prices and more, as the new benchmark.

This April is the official sunset of Level 2 for nearly all Visa commercial and small business cards, and other networks are on similar timelines. Money can move without data, but it will cost more, reconcile more slowly and invite scrutiny. For merchants willing to



invest in automation and integrity, the reward is not just lower fees, but a more profitable, more scalable way to do business.

Read also: [How Payments Automation Helps CFOs Keep Up With Their Own Data](#)

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The End of Good-Enough Data

Beginning in late 2025, Visa rolled out artificial intelligence-driven validation of what it now calls Product 3 data, a rebranding and tightening of what was previously known as Level 3. Mastercard has followed a parallel path with enhanced scrutiny under its Commercial Connect framework. These systems no longer check whether fields are populated; they verify whether the transaction math reconciles. Unit price multiplied by quantity, plus tax and freight, must equal the authorized total. Even minor rounding discrepancies can cause a transaction to fail validation.

From the networks' perspective, the push toward data integrity is defensive and strategic. AI-powered spend management and agentic commerce require invoice-quality data to function. Enforcing that standard at the network level ensures consistency while feeding higher-quality data into fraud detection and analytics systems.

[Zach Lynn](#), head of customer data and insights at [Boost Payment Solutions](#), wrote in the PYMNTS eBook "[Headlines That Will Shape the Close of 2025](#)" that [data exchange](#) has become non-negotiable in the payments industry.

"In today's environment, seamless, secure data flows between buyers, suppliers and financial institutions are essential," Lynn wrote. "Whether it is enabling real-time reconciliation or supporting advanced analytics, the ability to move and leverage data is now table stakes for any organization serious about optimizing working capital."

Until recently, commercial card transactions operated on an honor system. Merchants could pass along additional data, like tax totals, purchase order numbers and line-item detail, to qualify for lower



interchange rates. In practice, much of that data was messy. Gateways auto-filled fields with zeros. Descriptions were generic. Arithmetic inconsistencies were common. The data existed, but it was rarely audited.

At first glance, the updated data requirements may sound like a compliance headache. For many merchants, they may end up becoming one. Failed validation can result in immediate downgrades to standard interchange rates, often increasing costs by 40% to 50% on affected transactions. But for merchants who adapt, the same system creates a clear, repeatable way to make more money without raising prices or volume.

See also: [Why Smart CFOs Are Rethinking How Money Moves](#)

How Automation Is Becoming a New Margin Lever

As the April transition deadline approaches for merchants, the networks' technical updates to commercial interchange are evolving into a structural change in how value is distributed across the B2B payments ecosystem. Accuracy, once treated as overhead, is now a measurable asset. Payments, once a cost center, are becoming a place where disciplined merchants can outperform their peers.

“[Payments](#) are no longer a commodity,” Boost Payment Solutions Chief Revenue Officer [Seth Goodman](#) told PYMNTS in October. “They’re truly a strategic advantage when properly optimized.”

The merchants best positioned to benefit from this system share the common trait of automation. Specifically, they have direct integrations between their ERP or invoicing systems and their payment gateways. When line-item data flows programmatically from invoice to authorization without manual re-entry, the risk of arithmetic mismatch drops. What once seemed like an IT hygiene project now functions as a margin optimization strategy.

This is where the story turns from payments infrastructure to business strategy. Clean transaction data does more than reduce interchange. It accelerates reconciliation, shortens days sales outstanding and reduces disputes. For buyers using modern spend management platforms, it improves visibility and control, making



verified merchants easier to work with. Over time, that ease translates into preference, faster approvals and repeat business.

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OpenAI Says AI Will Help Handle Household Chores

BY PYMNTS
JANUARY 7, 2026



Some people worry that artificial intelligence will replace them at their jobs.

But [OpenAI](#)'s chief economist said AI will soon help people with the jobs they do at home.

[Aaron "Ronnie" Chatterji](#) said AI will help save time on household chores, adding that the technology will assist millions of people in ways that traditional economic statistics do not cover, the Financial Times [reported](#) Wednesday (Jan. 8).

"This is something people aren't necessarily thinking about when they think about the impact of AI," he said, per the report. "Taking care of those tasks that would have taken us a long time."

The argument came amid debate about whether generative AI tools like OpenAI's [ChatGPT](#) will lead to the sweeping gains in productivity Silicon Valley has promised, the report said. At the same time, others warn that AI could usher in [job losses](#).

OpenAI has contended the technology is transformative in other ways that are difficult to gauge, with CEO [Sam Altman](#) saying on



“[The Tonight Show](#)” last month that he could not “imagine having gone through figuring out how to raise a newborn without ChatGPT.”

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Research from OpenAI rival [Anthropic](#) suggested that people using its [Claude](#) chatbot for guidance in food preparation sped up the process by 75%, according to the report.

Chatterji said he wants to find “new ways to measure human value,” with a special emphasis on how workers collaborate, and on measuring domestic labor, per the report.

“Whether it’s caring for children or doing household chores, these are things that need to get done,” Chatterji said, according to the report.

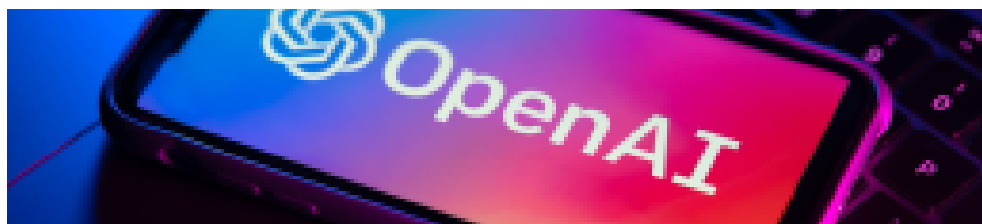
Chatterji’s department’s work has been criticized for selective research and for publishing work that supports OpenAI’s technology, the report said.

The report followed findings published by OpenAI this week showing that 40 million people use ChatGPT each day for [health](#)-related questions, with health prompts now making up more than 5% of all messages sent to ChatGPT worldwide. Among the platform’s roughly 800 million weekly users, about 200 million engage with health topics at least once per week.

Meanwhile, the PYMNTS Intelligence report “[How AI Becomes the Place Consumers Start Everything](#)” found that more than 60% of consumers in the United States used a dedicated AI platform in the last year.

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